Asian have expanded, while its operational integration with the jihadi nexus in Pakistan has grown.

Storming the World Stage traces Lashkar's evolution since its inception in order to assess its effects on the security of India, Pakistan and the West as well as on the stability of South Asia. The book consists of three parts: Part I contextualizes the group's evolution by discussing first the jihadi milieu in which it developed (Chapter 1) and then its ideological and strategic precepts as they developed during its formative years and which inform its behavior (Chapter 2). The remainder of the book proceeds chronologically. The second part focuses on the group's activities in the 1990s: Chapter 3 details Lashkar's activities in Indian-administered Kashmir, and Chapter 4 explains how the group built its infrastructure in Pakistan as well as its transnational networks abroad. Chapter 5 focuses on two inflection points for Lashkar, its jihadi brethren and the Pakistani state in late 2001: the 9/11 attacks and the decision by the Musharraf regime (taken under intense international pressure) to outlaw Lashkar and several other jihadi outfits following an assault by Pakistani militants on the Indian Parliament in December. Forewarned of the impending ban, MDI changed its name to Jamaat-ul-Dawa [JuD], that of Saeed's initial missionary organization. JuD leaders claimed the new organization was entirely discrete from the outlawed Lashkar; in reality, many jihadi groups orchestrated name changes of this sort in concert with the Pakistani security services to protect their leadership and assets. Lashkar and JuD remained two wings of the same organization. The third part is dedicated to Lashkar's evolution from 2002 onwards. Chapters 6 and 7 look at the group's development from roughly 2002–2005 and 2005–2008 respectively. Taken together these two chapters illustrate the evolving contours of its jihad against India and Lashkar's expanding focus on the fight against America and its allies. They also detail the repercussions of its increasing collaboration with other militants. Chapter 8 is dedicated to exploring the objectives, planning and execution of the Mumbai attacks in detail, while Chapter 9 revisits Lashkar's activities on multiple fronts to demonstrate how the group has expanded since Mumbai. The final chapter spotlights some of the possible implications this may have for Lashkar as well as for India, Pakistan and the West.

When gathering information I relied a great deal on field research conducted in Pakistan and India. Owing to the sensitivity of the material,